NAT OTA Booking Process (OCTO API)

Step by step: how a booking travels from the OTA, through OCTO, into NAT

Request sent — Reply sent back — Box: What happens inside that system

Customer	OTA	OCTO API	NAT Booking Software	Tour Calendar
Traveler booking the tour	Headout, CHD and other OCTO partners	Standard booking connection	Your booking system	Dates, times and seats

STEP A · FIND A TOUR — The customer searches, the OTA asks NAT what is available

1. **Searches for a tour** (Customer → OTA) — Picks a date and number of guests
2. **OCTO Availability: Are seats free on this date?** (OTA → NAT) — Tour, date, number of guests
3. **Checks the request** (NAT) — Booking cutoff time, min / max guests for this OTA
   Reads live seats (Tour Calendar) — Seats left on each tour time
4. **OCTO Availability: Available times, seats and prices** (NAT → OTA) — Straight from your calendar
5. **Shows times and prices** (OTA → Customer) — Customer chooses a time

STEP B · HOLD THE SEATS — Customer clicks Book, NAT reserves the seats before payment

6. **Clicks Book** (Customer → OTA) — Enters name, email and phone
7. **OCTO Create booking: Hold these seats for us** (OTA → NAT) — Tour, time, guests (adult, child, infant)
8. **Creates a booking on hold** (NAT) — Held for a set time, usually 30 minutes, or as the client requests. The OTA can extend it. ON HOLD
   Seats locked (Tour Calendar) — No other OTA can sell them now. HELD
9. **OCTO Create booking: Seats held, here is the booking ID** (NAT → OTA) — OTA can now take payment

STEP C · BOOKING ON THE OTA — The customer pays, the OTA confirms the booking and emails the customer

10. **Pays for the tour** (Customer → OTA) — Payment is taken by the OTA
11. **OTA creates and confirms its booking** (OTA) — With its own reference, for example 12345. CONFIRMED
12. **Confirmation email and ticket** (OTA → Customer) — Sent by the OTA, not by NAT

STEP D · CONFIRM IN NAT — The OTA passes the confirmation to NAT through OCTO

13. **OCTO Confirm booking: Booking confirmed, please confirm in NAT** (OTA → NAT) — Customer name, email, phone, OTA reference
14. **Creates the confirmed booking** (NAT) — Reference HEAD-12345, paid by Headout, shown on the dashboard and OTA report. CONFIRMED
    Seats booked (Tour Calendar) — Seat count updated for every OTA. BOOKED
15. **OCTO Confirm booking: Reply: confirmed** (NAT → OTA) — NAT answers the same confirm request. No separate message.

STEP E · AFTER THE BOOKING — Changes and cancellations use the same OCTO path

16. **OCTO Update booking: Change guests, time or contact details** (OTA → NAT) — NAT re-checks seats and cutoff, then updates
17. **OCTO Cancel booking: Cancel this booking** (OTA → NAT) — NAT cancels and frees the seats, unless the cancellation window has passed
18. **If the OTA never confirms** (NAT) — The hold expires and the seats go back on sale. EXPIRED
    Seats released (Tour Calendar) — Available again on every OTA

Why seats are held first

NAT holds the seats before the customer pays, so no other OTA can sell the same seats during checkout.

Two bookings, one link

The OTA keeps its own booking, and NAT creates a matching one with the OTA's reference (for example HEAD-12345), so both sides can always find it.

Every step goes through OCTO

OCTO is the travel industry's standard booking language. Any OTA that speaks OCTO can connect to NAT the same way.